

# 01

## The King's Indian Attack from First Principles

A setup, not a shortcut: what White is building and what Black receives in return.



### THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

*You will understand the KIA as a flexible way to reach familiar structures while reading Black's center, rather than as seven automatic moves.*

## LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

# A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

## 1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

## 2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

## 3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate White's candidates, find Black's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

## 4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

## THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

*Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.*

## SIX LINKED LESSONS

# Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 001 | PAGE 4

## Decode: The universal-looking shell

*The KIA is a decision system: read Black's center before completing White's shell.*

LESSON 002 | PAGE 8

## Play: The universal-looking shell

*The KIA is a decision system: read Black's center before completing White's shell.*

LESSON 003 | PAGE 12

## Decode: The 1.e4 route against the French

*The 1.e4 KIA reaches a French shell; e5 must be earned, not scheduled.*

LESSON 004 | PAGE 16

## Play: The 1.e4 route against the French

*The 1.e4 KIA reaches a French shell; e5 must be earned, not scheduled.*

LESSON 005 | PAGE 20

## Decode: The 1.Nf3 flexible route

*A flexible move order is valuable only if it creates a better choice later.*

LESSON 006 | PAGE 24

## Play: The 1.Nf3 flexible route

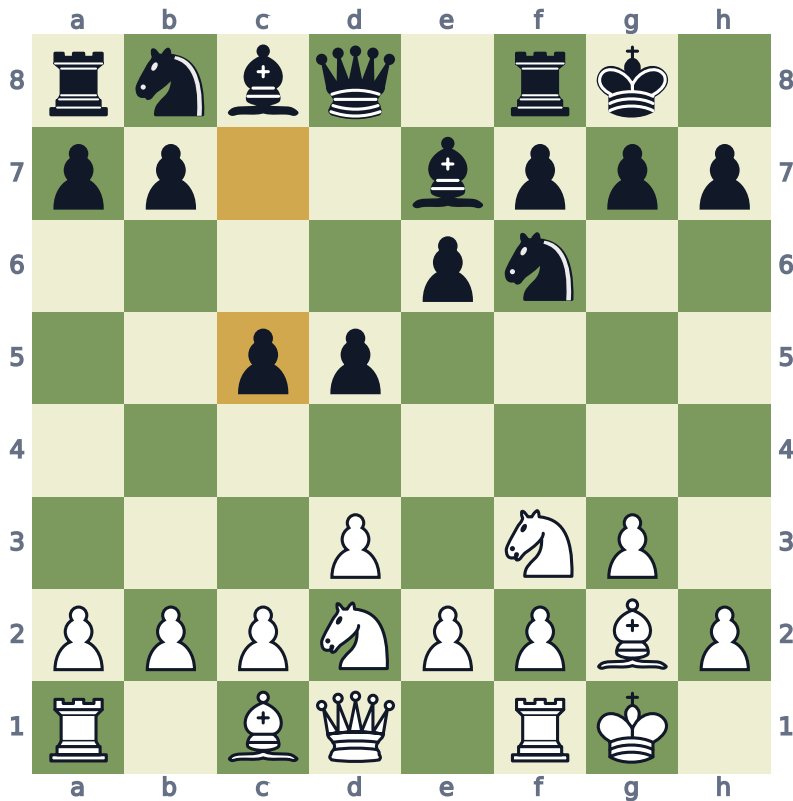
*A flexible move order is valuable only if it creates a better choice later.*

### VOLUME OBJECTIVE

You will understand the KIA as a flexible way to reach familiar structures while reading Black's center, rather than as seven automatic moves.

## DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

# Decode: The universal-looking shell



## WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Nf3, g3, Bg2, O-O, d3, Nbd2, e4, and Re1 form a recognizable shell, but their order must respond to Black's central breaks.

## DECISION RULE

Which black pawn break is already possible, and does the next 'system move' prevent it or merely ignore it?

## SIDE TO MOVE

White

## BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses the space White concedes to claim d5, expand with ...c5 or ...b5, and seek a central break before the kingside buildup matures.

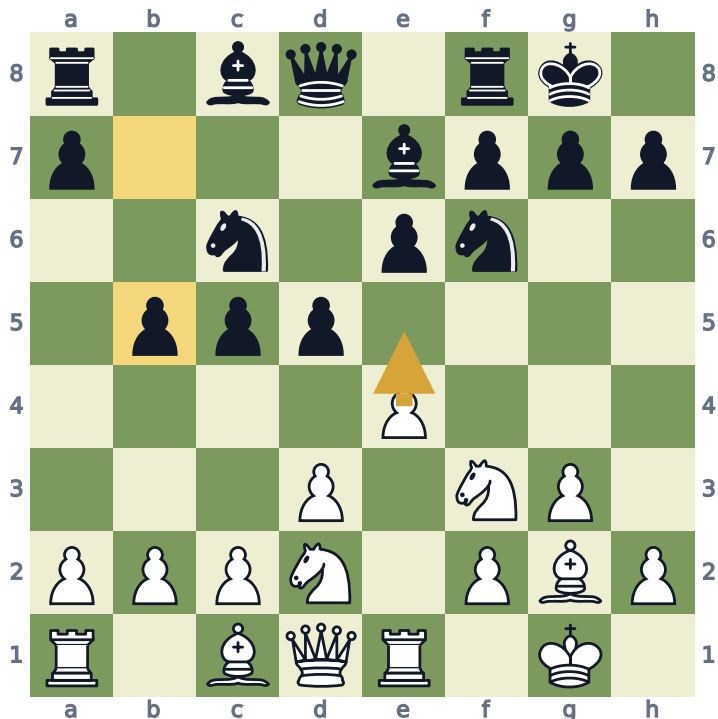
## WHITE'S PLAN

White completes development, keeps e4 secure, and chooses e5, exd5, or a different center according to Black's pawn placement.

**MEMORY RULE |** The KIA is a decision system: read Black's center before completing White's shell.

CUE -&gt; REASON -&gt; MOVE -&gt; REPLY -&gt; NEW POSITION

# The plan map



## CUE

Nf3, g3, Bg2, O-O, d3, Nbd2, e4, and Re1 form a recognizable shell, but their order must respond to Black's central breaks.

## BLACK AIMS FOR

Black uses the space White concedes to claim d5, expand with ...c5 or ...b5, and seek a central break before the kingside buildup matures.

## FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

## WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White completes development, keeps e4 secure, and chooses e5, exd5, or a different center according to Black's pawn placement.

## FAILURE MODE

Playing the setup from memory while Black achieves an ideal center without paying a price.

## DECISION TEST

Ask: Which black pawn break is already possible, and does the next 'system move' prevent it or merely ignore it? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

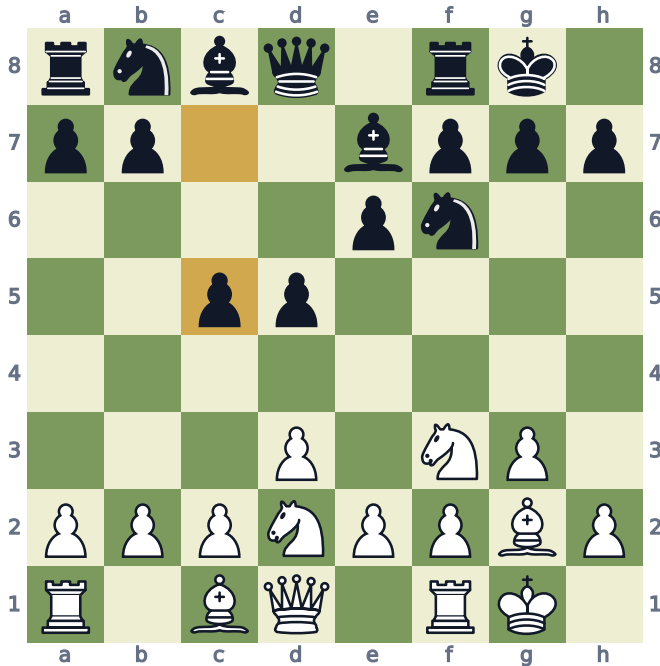
**RULE | The KIA is a decision system: read Black's center before completing White's shell.**

## INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

# Move-by-move meaning

## REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 b5



- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- d3: White supports e4 and keeps the center compact at the cost of space on d4.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nbd2: White reroutes a knight to d2; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.

## WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Nf3, g3, Bg2, O-O, d3, Nbd2, e4, and Re1 form a recognizable shell, but their order must respond to Black's central breaks.

## WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which black pawn break is already possible, and does the next 'system move' prevent it or merely ignore it? White's attacking or positional plan is: White completes development, keeps e4 secure, and chooses e5, exd5, or a different center according to Black's pawn placement. The line fails as a template when: Playing the setup from memory while Black achieves an ideal center without paying a price.

**STORE THIS | The KIA is a decision system: read Black's center before completing White's shell.**

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

# Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

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3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

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5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

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## ANSWER KEY

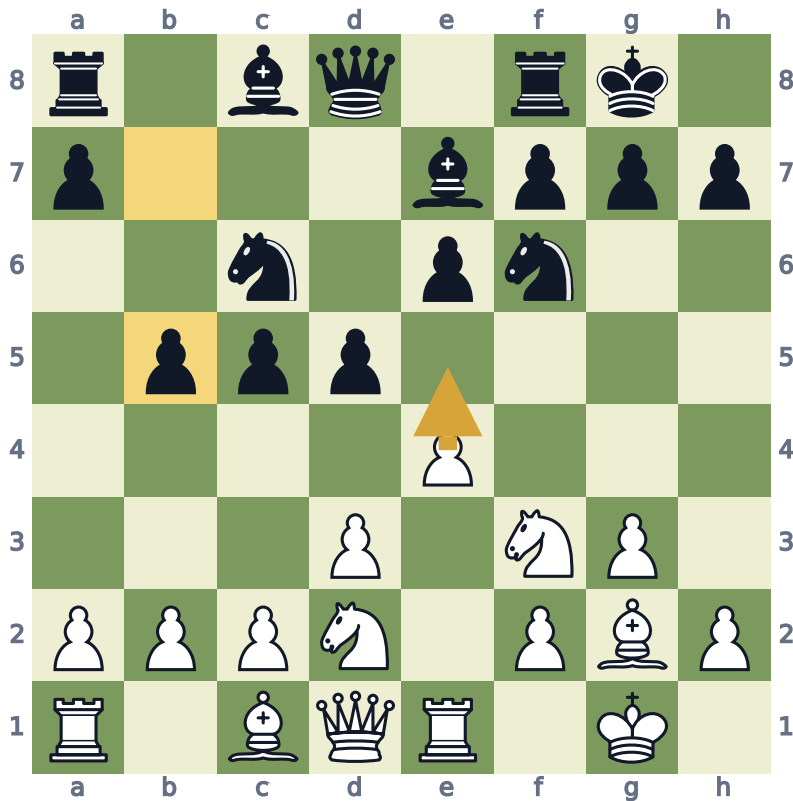
1. Nf3, g3, Bg2, O-O, d3, Nbd2, e4, and Re1 form a recognizable shell, but their order must respond to Black's central breaks. 2. Black uses the space White concedes to claim d5, expand with ...c5 or ...b5, and seek a central break before the kingside buildup matures. 3. White completes development, keeps e4 secure, and chooses e5, exd5, or a different center according to Black's pawn placement. 4. Which black pawn break is already possible, and does the next 'system move' prevent it or merely ignore it? 5. Playing the setup from memory while Black achieves an ideal center without paying a price.

## BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5

## PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

# Play: The universal-looking shell



## WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Nf3, g3, Bg2, O-O, d3, Nbd2, e4, and Re1 form a recognizable shell, but their order must respond to Black's central breaks.

## DECISION RULE

Which black pawn break is already possible, and does the next 'system move' prevent it or merely ignore it?

## SIDE TO MOVE

White

## BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

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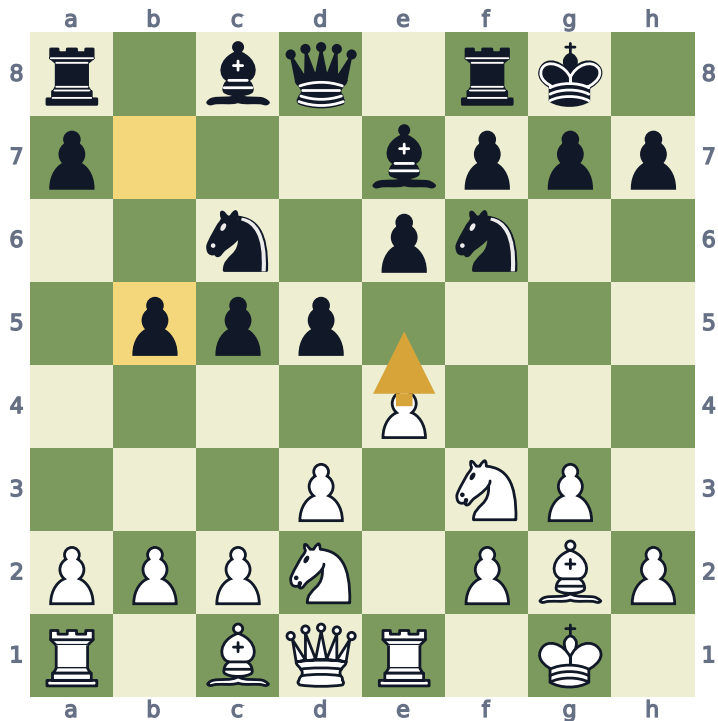
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White completes development, keeps e4 secure, and chooses e5, exd5, or a different center according to Black's pawn placement.

**MEMORY RULE |** The KIA is a decision system: read Black's center before completing White's shell.

CUE -&gt; REASON -&gt; MOVE -&gt; REPLY -&gt; NEW POSITION

# The plan map



## CUE

Nf3, g3, Bg2, O-O, d3, Nbd2, e4, and Re1 form a recognizable shell, but their order must respond to Black's central breaks.

## BLACK AIMS FOR

Black uses the space White concedes to claim d5, expand with ...c5 or ...b5, and seek a central break before the kingside buildup matures.

## FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

## WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White completes development, keeps e4 secure, and chooses e5, exd5, or a different center according to Black's pawn placement.

## FAILURE MODE

Playing the setup from memory while Black achieves an ideal center without paying a price.

## DECISION TEST

Ask: Which black pawn break is already possible, and does the next 'system move' prevent it or merely ignore it? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

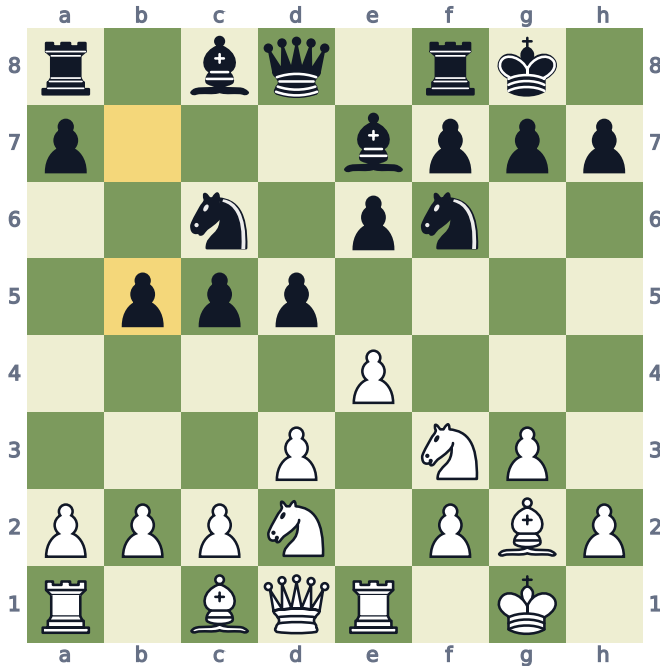
**RULE |** The KIA is a decision system: read Black's center before completing White's shell.

## INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

# Move-by-move meaning

## REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 b5



- Nbd2: White reroutes a knight to d2; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.
- e4: White builds the KIA center but must account for Black's immediate central break.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.

## WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Nf3, g3, Bg2, O-O, d3, Nbd2, e4, and Re1 form a recognizable shell, but their order must respond to Black's central breaks.

## WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which black pawn break is already possible, and does the next 'system move' prevent it or merely ignore it? White's attacking or positional plan is: White completes development, keeps e4 secure, and chooses e5, exd5, or a different center according to Black's pawn placement. The line fails as a template when: Playing the setup from memory while Black achieves an ideal center without paying a price.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

# Retrieval and self-coaching

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## ANSWER KEY

1. Nf3, g3, Bg2, O-O, d3, Nbd2, e4, and Re1 form a recognizable shell, but their order must respond to Black's central breaks. 2. Black uses the space White concedes to claim d5, expand with ...c5 or ...b5, and seek a central break before the kingside buildup matures. 3. White completes development, keeps e4 secure, and chooses e5, exd5, or a different center according to Black's pawn placement. 4. Which black pawn break is already possible, and does the next 'system move' prevent it or merely ignore it? 5. Playing the setup from memory while Black achieves an ideal center without paying a price.

## BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 b5

## DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

# Decode: The 1.e4 route against the French



## WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Starting with 1.e4 invites a French structure while d3 and Nd2 keep White out of the main French center and preserve the KIA plan.

## DECISION RULE

If White plays e5 now, where must the f3 knight go after ...Nd7, and can Black challenge the pawn chain?

## SIDE TO MOVE

White

## BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black develops naturally, gains space with ...d5 and ...c5, and attacks the base of White's center before e5 becomes stable.

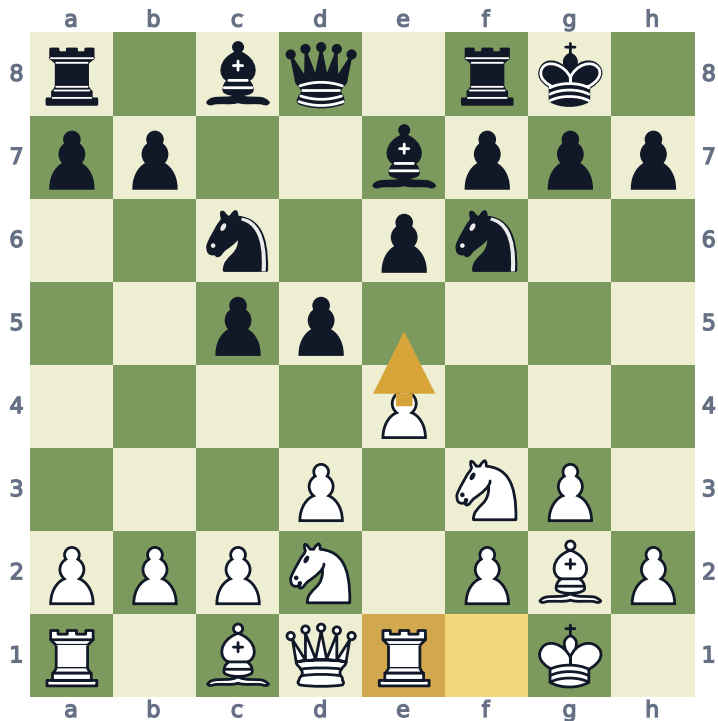
## WHITE'S PLAN

White secures e4, develops the kingside, and prepares e5 only when the resulting closed center favors a kingside attack.

**MEMORY RULE |** The 1.e4 KIA reaches a French shell; e5 must be earned, not scheduled.

CUE -&gt; REASON -&gt; MOVE -&gt; REPLY -&gt; NEW POSITION

# The plan map



## CUE

Starting with 1.e4 invites a French structure while d3 and Nd2 keep White out of the main French center and preserve the KIA plan.

## BLACK AIMS FOR

Black develops naturally, gains space with ...d5 and ...c5, and attacks the base of White's center before e5 becomes stable.

## FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

## WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White secures e4, develops the kingside, and prepares e5 only when the resulting closed center favors a kingside attack.

## FAILURE MODE

Believing the opening name guarantees an attack even when e5 is tactically premature.

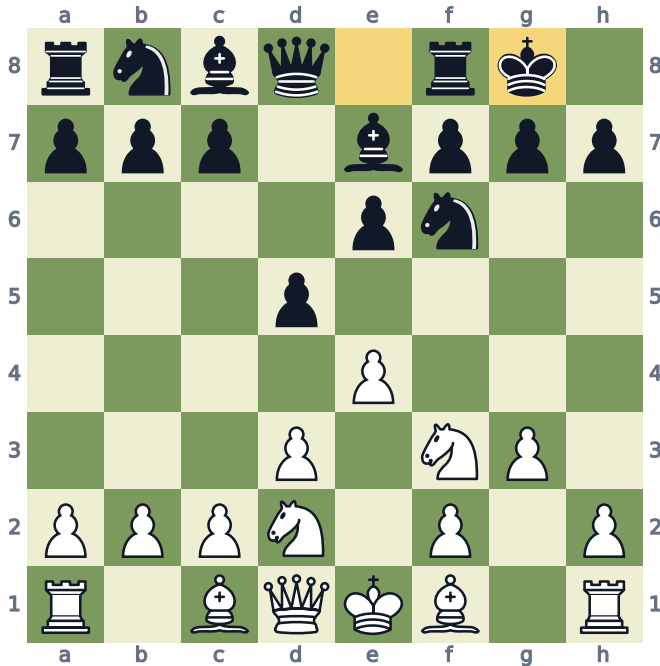
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Ask: If White plays e5 now, where must the f3 knight go after ...Nd7, and can Black challenge the pawn chain? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

**RULE | The 1.e4 KIA reaches a French shell; e5 must be earned, not scheduled.**

## Move-by-move meaning

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1



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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

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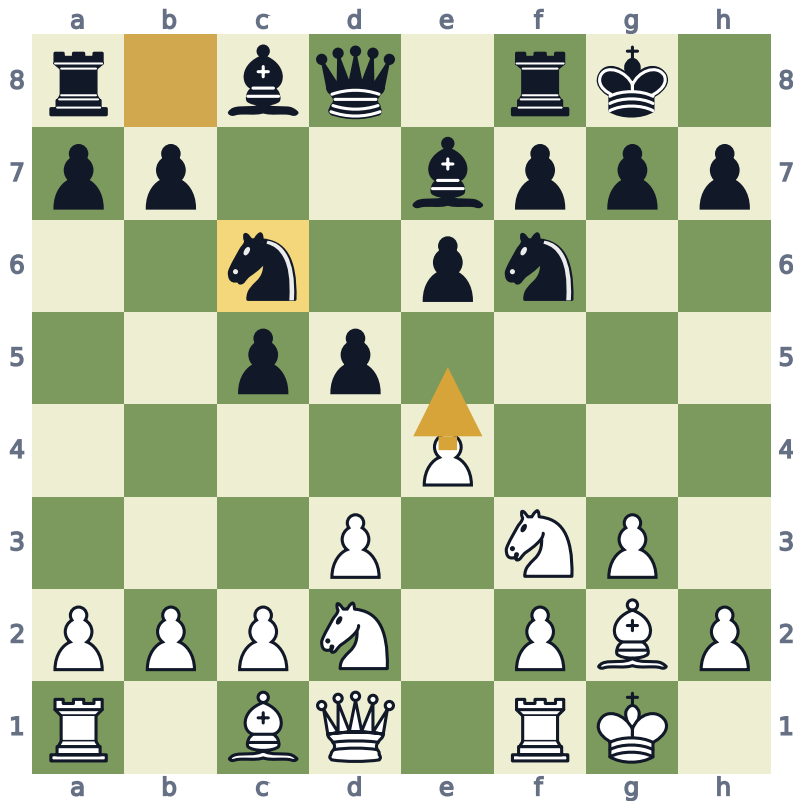
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## BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 10 plies from memory, then replay: 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O

## PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

# Play: The 1.e4 route against the French



## WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

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## DECISION RULE

If White plays e5 now, where must the f3 knight go after ...Nd7, and can Black challenge the pawn chain?

## SIDE TO MOVE

White

## BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

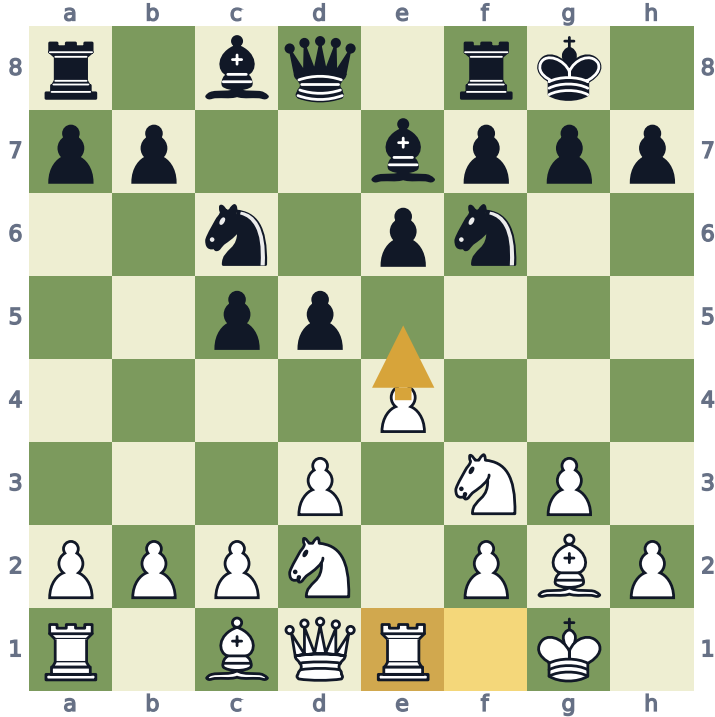
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Starting with 1.e4 invites a French structure while d3 and Nd2 keep White out of the main French center and preserve the KIA plan.

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White secures e4, develops the kingside, and prepares e5 only when the resulting closed center favors a kingside attack.

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Ask: If White plays e5 now, where must the f3 knight go after ...Nd7, and can Black challenge the pawn chain? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

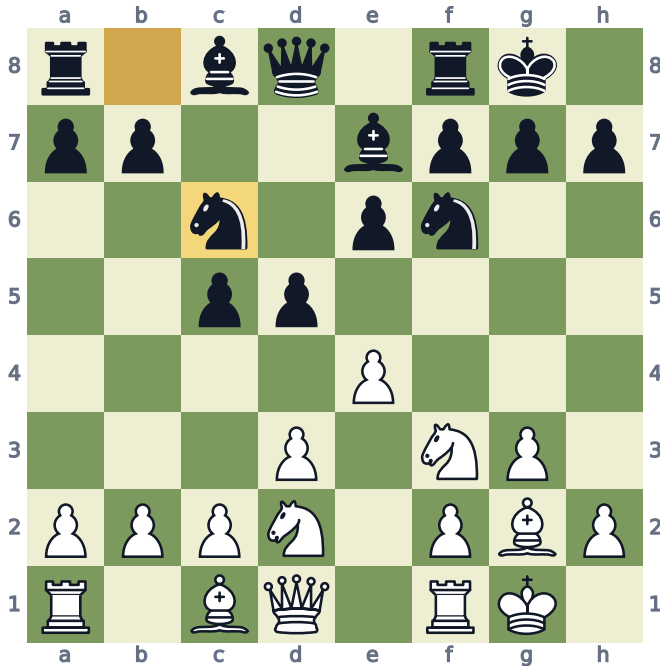
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## INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

# Move-by-move meaning

## REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1



- g3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.

## WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Starting with 1.e4 invites a French structure while d3 and Nd2 keep White out of the main French center and preserve the KIA plan.

## WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

If White plays e5 now, where must the f3 knight go after ...Nd7, and can Black challenge the pawn chain? White's attacking or positional plan is: White secures e4, develops the kingside, and prepares e5 only when the resulting closed center favors a kingside attack. The line fails as a template when: Believing the opening name guarantees an attack even when e5 is tactically premature.

**STORE THIS | The 1.e4 KIA reaches a French shell; e5 must be earned, not scheduled.**

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

# Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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## ANSWER KEY

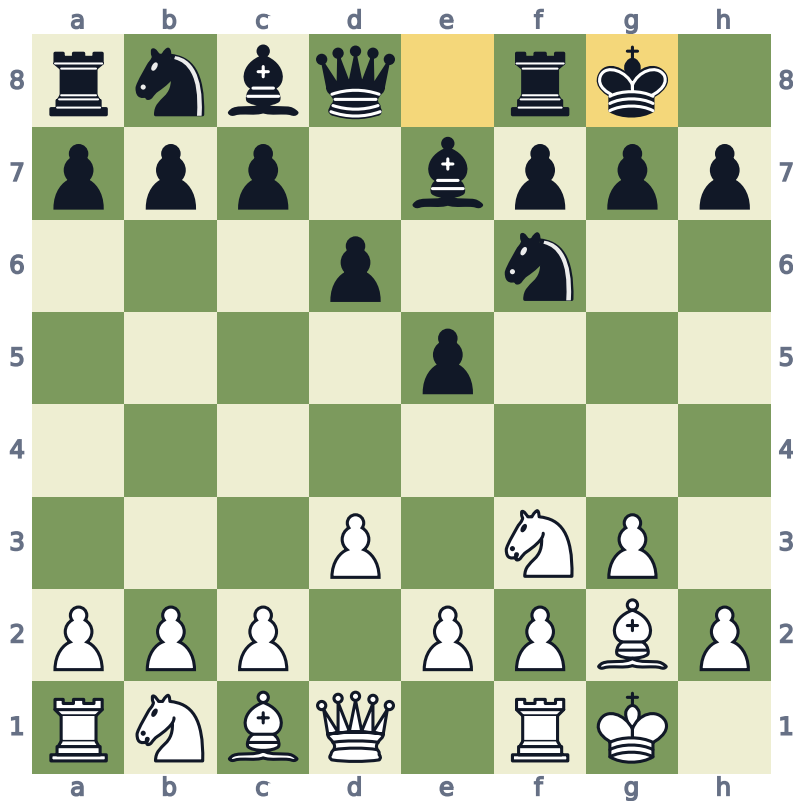
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## BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6

## DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

# Decode: The 1.Nf3 flexible route



## WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

1.Nf3 delays the central pawn commitment and can avoid some forcing defenses, but Black may choose an active ...e5 setup of its own.

## DECISION RULE

What center did Black choose, and which white pawn break challenges it without blocking the g2 bishop?

## SIDE TO MOVE

White

## BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black occupies the center, develops quickly, and prepares ...Re8 or ...d5 before White creates a space advantage.

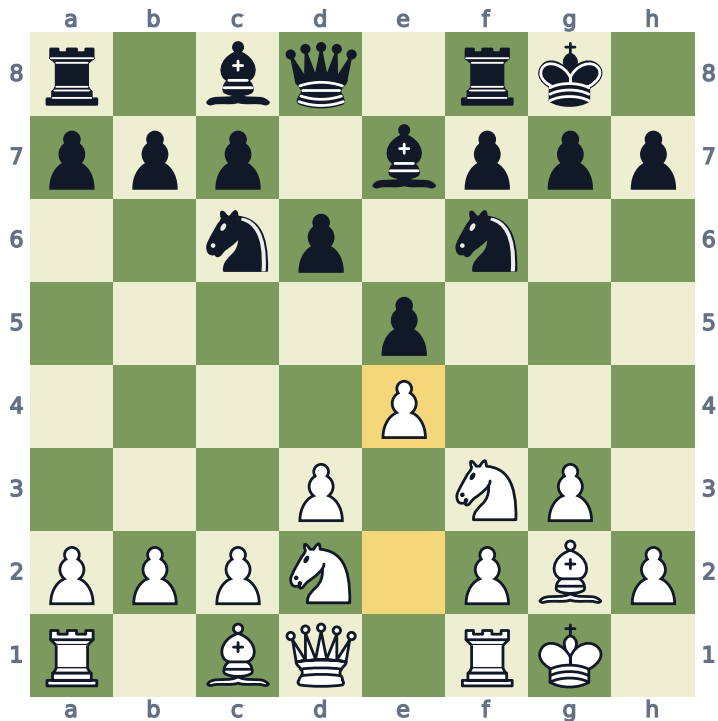
## WHITE'S PLAN

White uses the completed fianchetto to decide between a closed e4 center, c4 pressure, or a later d4 expansion.

**MEMORY RULE** | A flexible move order is valuable only if it creates a better choice later.

CUE -&gt; REASON -&gt; MOVE -&gt; REPLY -&gt; NEW POSITION

# The plan map



## CUE

1.Nf3 delays the central pawn commitment and can avoid some forcing defenses, but Black may choose an active ...e5 setup of its own.

## BLACK AIMS FOR

Black occupies the center, develops quickly, and prepares ...Re8 or ...d5 before White creates a space advantage.

## FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

## WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White uses the completed fianchetto to decide between a closed e4 center, c4 pressure, or a later d4 expansion.

## FAILURE MODE

Using flexibility only to postpone every central decision until Black controls all useful breaks.

## DECISION TEST

Ask: What center did Black choose, and which white pawn break challenges it without blocking the g2 bishop? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

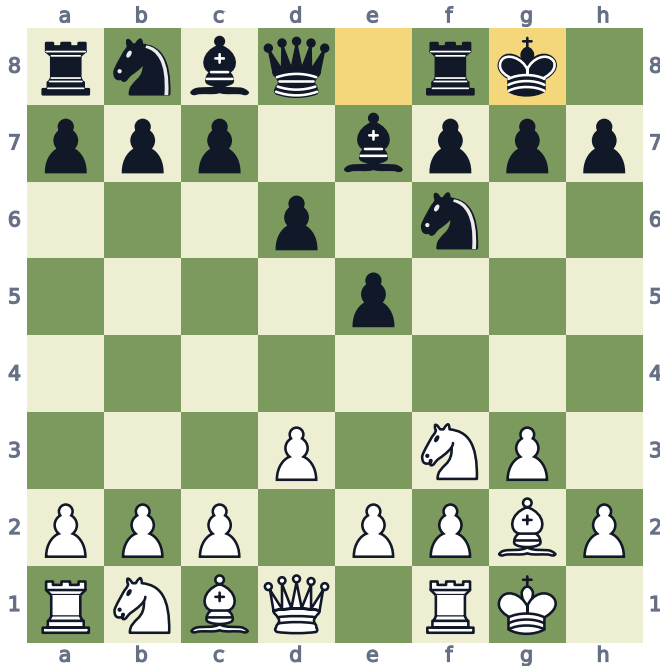
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## INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

# Move-by-move meaning

## REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d6 2. g3 e5 3. Bg2 Nf6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 Nc6 7. e4



- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- d3: White supports e4 and keeps the center compact at the cost of space on d4.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.

## WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

1.Nf3 delays the central pawn commitment and can avoid some forcing defenses, but Black may choose an active ...e5 setup of its own.

## WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What center did Black choose, and which white pawn break challenges it without blocking the g2 bishop? White's attacking or positional plan is: White uses the completed fianchetto to decide between a closed e4 center, c4 pressure, or a later d4 expansion. The line fails as a template when: Using flexibility only to postpone every central decision until Black controls all useful breaks.

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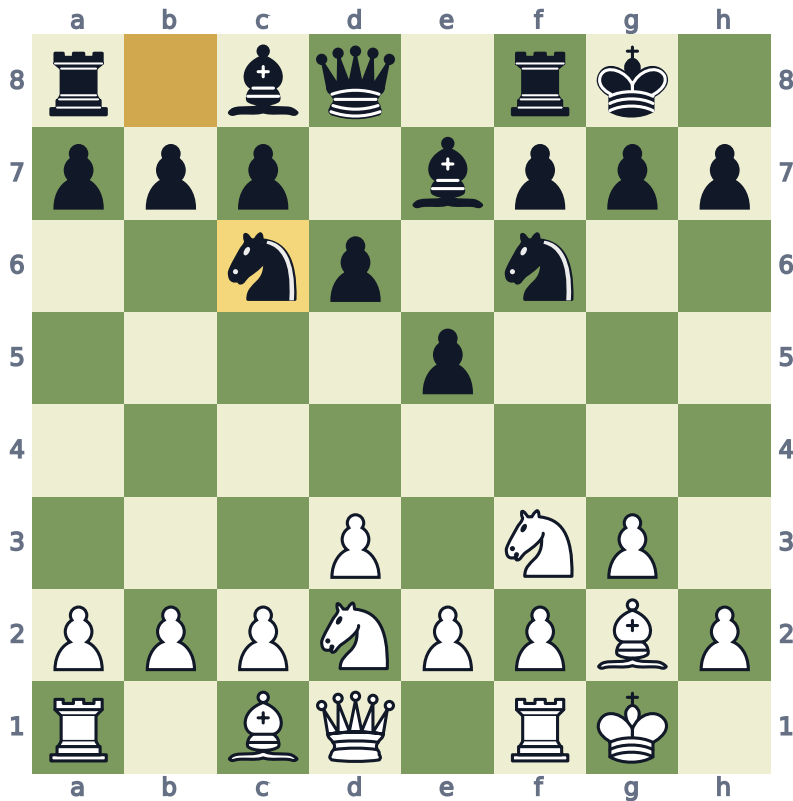
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## BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 10 plies from memory, then replay: 3. Bg2 Nf6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O

## PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

# Play: The 1.Nf3 flexible route



## WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

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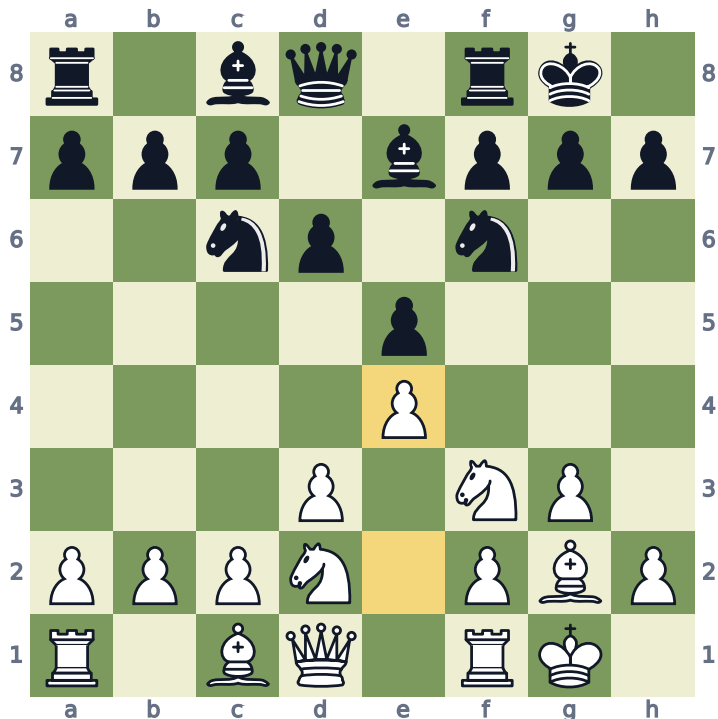
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White uses the completed fianchetto to decide between a closed e4 center, c4 pressure, or a later d4 expansion.

**MEMORY RULE** | A flexible move order is valuable only if it creates a better choice later.

CUE -&gt; REASON -&gt; MOVE -&gt; REPLY -&gt; NEW POSITION

# The plan map



## CUE

1.Nf3 delays the central pawn commitment and can avoid some forcing defenses, but Black may choose an active ...e5 setup of its own.

## BLACK AIMS FOR

Black occupies the center, develops quickly, and prepares ...Re8 or ...d5 before White creates a space advantage.

## FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

## WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White uses the completed fianchetto to decide between a closed e4 center, c4 pressure, or a later d4 expansion.

## FAILURE MODE

Using flexibility only to postpone every central decision until Black controls all useful breaks.

## DECISION TEST

Ask: What center did Black choose, and which white pawn break challenges it without blocking the g2 bishop? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

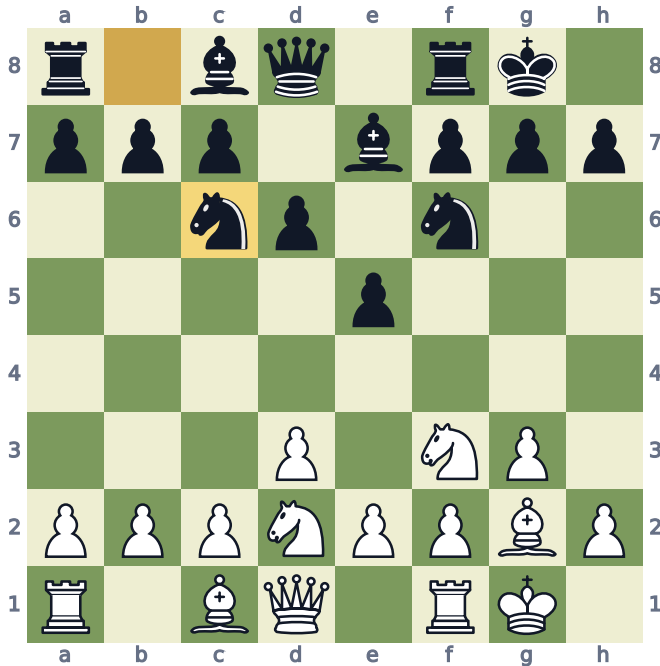
**RULE** | A flexible move order is valuable only if it creates a better choice later.

## INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

# Move-by-move meaning

## REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d6 2. g3 e5 3. Bg2 Nf6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 Nc6 7. e4



- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- d3: White supports e4 and keeps the center compact at the cost of space on d4.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nbd2: White reroutes a knight to d2; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.

## WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

1.Nf3 delays the central pawn commitment and can avoid some forcing defenses, but Black may choose an active ...e5 setup of its own.

## WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What center did Black choose, and which white pawn break challenges it without blocking the g2 bishop? White's attacking or positional plan is: White uses the completed fianchetto to decide between a closed e4 center, c4 pressure, or a later d4 expansion. The line fails as a template when: Using flexibility only to postpone every central decision until Black controls all useful breaks.

**STORE THIS | A flexible move order is valuable only if it creates a better choice later.**

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

# Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

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3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

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4. What exact question decides the next move?

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5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

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## ANSWER KEY

1. 1.Nf3 delays the central pawn commitment and can avoid some forcing defenses, but Black may choose an active ...e5 setup of its own. 2. Black occupies the center, develops quickly, and prepares ...Re8 or ...d5 before White creates a space advantage. 3. White uses the completed fianchetto to decide between a closed e4 center, c4 pressure, or a later d4 expansion. 4. What center did Black choose, and which white pawn break challenges it without blocking the g2 bishop? 5. Using flexibility only to postpone every central decision until Black controls all useful breaks.

## BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 Nc6

## SIX-POSITION TEST

# Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

## LESSON 001 Decode: The universal-looking shell

Prompt: Which black pawn break is already possible, and does the next 'system move' prevent it or merely ignore it?

Recall: The KIA is a decision system: read Black's center before completing White's shell.

## LESSON 002 Play: The universal-looking shell

Prompt: Which black pawn break is already possible, and does the next 'system move' prevent it or merely ignore it?

Recall: The KIA is a decision system: read Black's center before completing White's shell.

## LESSON 003 Decode: The 1.e4 route against the French

Prompt: If White plays e5 now, where must the f3 knight go after ...Nd7, and can Black challenge the pawn chain?

Recall: The 1.e4 KIA reaches a French shell; e5 must be earned, not scheduled.

## LESSON 004 Play: The 1.e4 route against the French

Prompt: If White plays e5 now, where must the f3 knight go after ...Nd7, and can Black challenge the pawn chain?

Recall: The 1.e4 KIA reaches a French shell; e5 must be earned, not scheduled.

## LESSON 005 Decode: The 1.Nf3 flexible route

Prompt: What center did Black choose, and which white pawn break challenges it without blocking the g2 bishop?

Recall: A flexible move order is valuable only if it creates a better choice later.

## LESSON 006 Play: The 1.Nf3 flexible route

Prompt: What center did Black choose, and which white pawn break challenges it without blocking the g2 bishop?

Recall: A flexible move order is valuable only if it creates a better choice later.

### PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's counterplay, White's plan, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

## THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

# One-page repertoire memory sheet

## CARD 1

## The universal-looking shell

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 b5

Decision: Which black pawn break is already possible, and does the next 'system move' prevent it or merely ignore it?

**Memory: The KIA is a decision system: read Black's center before completing White's shell.**

## CARD 2

## The 1.e4 route against the French

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1

Decision: If White plays e5 now, where must the f3 knight go after ...Nd7, and can Black challenge the pawn chain?

**Memory: The 1.e4 KIA reaches a French shell; e5 must be earned, not scheduled.**

## CARD 3

## The 1.Nf3 flexible route

1. Nf3 d6 2. g3 e5 3. Bg2 Nf6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 Nc6 7. e4

Decision: What center did Black choose, and which white pawn break challenges it without blocking the g2 bishop?

**Memory: A flexible move order is valuable only if it creates a better choice later.**

*Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.*

## SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

# Volume mastery tracker

| Lesson                                        | D1                       | D3                       | D7                       | D14                      | D30                      | Game                     | Pass                     |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| 001 Decode: The universal-looking shell       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 002 Play: The universal-looking shell         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 003 Decode: The 1.e4 route against the French | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 004 Play: The 1.e4 route against the French   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 005 Decode: The 1.Nf3 flexible route          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 006 Play: The 1.Nf3 flexible route            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

## TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

## PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name Black's strongest counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

*Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.*